



The First Half Term

Seven weeks with a Year 12 form, in order. The form comes from several schools, free periods are the new problem, and the tutor slot is shorter than everybody else's.

Sixth form. Sixth form tutor time is short and often skipped, so this half term is built out of five- and ten-minute pieces. The one thing that cannot be skipped is week four.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The seven weeks. What happens in each one, and what it is setting up.
Page 3	Print once. Everything the seven weeks needs, in the order you need it.
Page 4	The five routines, and the sheet you fill in as the half term goes.

Four things worth knowing first

	Why
Half of them do not know And each other	none of them will admit it. A Year 12 form that looks settled in week one is usually four schools sitting in four groups.
The new problem is the free period	Not the work. Nobody has ever asked them to decide what an hour is for, and nobody will chase them when they decide wrong.
Nobody is chasing them any more	That is the point of sixth form, and also how a student can disappear within a fortnight. Week four is there to catch it.
Finish what you started	Everything begun in week one is closed in week seven. This is the year group that will notice if it is not.

By half term the aim is not that they like each other. It is that the morning runs itself, and that you know which three you have not really spoken to.





The seven weeks

Sixth form. One new thing a week, and everything started in week one is closed in week seven.

Week	What happens	What it is setting up
Week 1	The Two-Minute Interview. Start By Half Term the same week, closed in week seven.	That this is a form and not a queue.
Week 2	The free period. Fifteen minutes of honest talk about what they did with last week's, and what one free period next week is for. No sheet, and no judgement in the room.	That unstructured time is something this form talks about out loud.
Week 3	Weekly Wonder, with the sixth form questions. Five to ten minutes, and the only thing in the week that each other and not only to you. is not about a deadline.	That people in this form talk to each other and not only to you.
Week 4	The Check-In Record Sheet, amber for anybody you have not really seen. The slot is short, so the sheet does the remembering.	That nobody gets through a half term unseen.
Week 5	Questions to Ask at an Open Evening, five mornings, before the open days. If your form includes Year 13s who are applying, The Personal Statement starts the same week.	That the next step is an ordinary subject of conversation rather than a January panic.
Week 6	Your one-to-one round, with The Quiet Word. In a sixth form the person most likely to notice a student who is struggling is a friend rather than you, which is worth saying out loud.	That a quiet word is normal, and that they can ask for one.
Week 7	By Half Term, closed. Then the free period conversation again, with what has actually changed since week two.	That things get finished.

If your school runs a whole-school induction in the first week, start this in week two and let it finish the half term. The order matters more than the dates.





Print once

Everything the seven weeks asks for, in the order it is needed, so the trip to the photocopier happens once. All of it is free on thepastoralguide.com.

What	When you need it	How many
Two-Minute Interview	The first morning	One set of cards, cut once
By Half Term	Week one, closed in week seven	One per student
Weekly Wonder	Week three onwards	The sixth form set, one copy
Check-In Record Sheet	Week four, then weekly	One, or use the spreadsheet
Open Evening Questions	Week five	The sixth form set, plus one sheet each
The Personal Statement	Week five, Year 13 only	Pages two to six, one per student
The Quiet Word	Week six	One for you, and cut the lanyard card out
Conversation Starters	In the drawer	One set of cards, cut once
Tell Me Later	On the wall from week one	A stack of slips, and a box

Tick them off as they come out of the printer. Everything on this list is print once and keep, apart from the sheets that say one per student.





The five routines

What should be running without you by half term, how each one is set, and the thing that tells you it has stuck.

The routine	How it is set	How you know it has stuck
Turning up	Registration starts at the same minute whether The number in the room goes up four of them are there or twenty. Say nothing about the others; start anyway.	in week three without you mentioning it.
The free period	Named out loud in week two and asked about every fortnight after. Never as a telling off, always as a question.	Somebody tells you what they changed without being asked.
Talking	Weekly Wonder on the same day each week. Five minutes is enough and ten is better.	The conversation carries on out of the door.
Noticing	The Check-In Record Sheet every Friday, amber for anybody you have not really spoken to this fortnight.	Nobody reaches half term still white on the sheet.
The next step	One thing about after sixth form every fortnight from week five, small and specific, rather than one careers assembly in March.	They start bringing it up themselves.

As you go

Week	What you set up	What did not stick
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

